

Good days coming for components manufacturers

The indigenous electronic components industry in India has never been able to grow to its full potential, primarily because the imported electronic components market flourished. The duty imposed on imported electronic components fell over time, which meant that local manufacturers found it hard to sustain themselves.

Now, things are taking a positive turn, primarily because of the government's aim to make defence manufacturing one of the key areas to focus on in the next ten years. With an increase in defence and aerospace manufacturing, electronic components manufacturing will also gain momentum. The government is very keen to encourage not only local players but is also inviting global firms to manufacture in India.

Tata Power recently announced it would set up a ₹ 4.5 billion defence manufacturing unit in Karnataka.

Grid-connected battery storage market to reach US\$ 8.3 billion

The growth in manufacturing capabilities and other technological advancements has been a boon for the grid-connected battery storage market. The government is coming up with subsidies and exciting tariffs to promote it. Commercialisation of this market is expected to start by 2017, which would be beneficial for companies with expertise in this segment.

According to Frost & Sullivan, the grid-connected battery storage market, which was worth a mere US\$ 0.46 billion in 2014, is expected to grow to US\$ 8.3 billion by 2024.

According to Ross Bruton, energy and power research analyst, Frost & Sullivan, "Battery storage has the ability to impart flexibility to the grid across a variety of end-use ap-

Appointments at IEEMA

Indian Electrical & Electronics Manufacturers' Association (IEEMA), the apex association of the Indian electrical equipment manufacturing industry, has appointed Babu Babel as president for the year 2015-16. Sanjeev Sardana, MD, Yamuna Power and Infrastructure Ltd, and Indra Prem Menon, president and CEO of Lakshmanan Isola Private Ltd, have been appointed as vice presidents.

Saurabh Grover appointed as country head, TPV Technology

Taiwan-based TPV Technology, manufacturer and seller of LED and LCD

applications. Its greatest advantages are the provision of distributed, variable renewable energy firming and energy time-shift, and rapid short-term electricity balancing for ancillary markets."

ESSCI, ESCI sets up a resource centre for solar electronics

Electronics Sector Skills Council of India (ESSCI) in partnership with Engineering Staff College of India (ESCI) has set up a centre of excellence, which is aimed at creating a large pool of talent in the sector of solar photovoltaics and electronics.

This is a first-of-its-kind centre in the south and will operate as a resource centre for skill development in the field of solar electronics and impart specialised training on solar technology, installation and maintenance. It aims to serve as an institution of high learning, technological leadership, research, support and training to create a skilled workforce for the solar electronics sector.

The centre has mandated ESSCI to create capacity in solar technology and meet the emerging needs of the sector in the region. ESSCI has one such facility in the north and plans to set up similar centres in the west and east zones.

In Focus

displays under AOC brand globally, has appointed Saurabh Grover as country head - India and SAARC.

Philips NV names Abhijit Bhattacharya as CFO

Philips NV has appointed Abhijit Bhattacharya as CFO. He previously worked as CFO of Philips' healthcare division and semiconductor company NXP.

CFO Rajiv Bansal quits Infosys

Infosys CFO Rajiv Bansal has resigned from the company. He will be replaced by M.D. Ranganath, who has been with the company for nearly 15 years.

Infineon, NSDC partner for semiconductor skill development

German semiconductor firm Infineon Technologies has partnered with National Skill Development Corp. (NSDC) to impart training to the youth on semiconductor or chip technology, aimed at boosting the electronic manufacturing ecosystem in India.

The semiconductor market in India is projected to grow by more than 20 per cent annually in the years to come. The two parties have signed an agreement through which they will support the Make in India initiative to make the country a manufacturing hub. The agreement involves the upskilling of workers, including the provision of material and expert trainers.

Infineon Technologies India managing director Vinay Shenoy has said that the company will not be making investment in India for setting up semiconductor manufacturing because of its existing plant's capacity.

AP to host India's largest mobile manufacturing hub

Three of India's local mobile handset makers, Micromax, Karbonn and Celkon, have decided to invest a sum of ₹ 7.5 billion in setting up